that because we are a responsible, democratic nation and not a rogue country like Pakistan,' said Ashfaq.

Even the DIA had acknowledged the role of Pakistan in sowing the seeds of the Taliban. In a report, it said the Taliban in the early 1990s began as a group of religious students who rejected the mujahideen takeover of Afghanistan. Due to Pakistani support, they became militarily powerful and at one point controlled approximately ninety per cent of Afghanistan. The report said:

Many Afghan opposition forces were outnumbered and outgunned by Taliban forces and could not fight the Taliban forces directly. The former Mujahideen Commander Ahmad Shah Mas-soud managed to form the Northern Alliance Forces (NAF) and continued his fight against Taliban forces in northern Afghanistan. Through Northern Alliance's Intelligence efforts, Massoud gained limited knowledge regarding the intentions of the Saudi millionaire Osama bin Laden and his terrorist organization Al-Qaeda to perform a terrorist act against the US.

The Indian spy agency feared that the Taliban would not waste time in killing Najibullah once they gained dominance in the war. Ved Asthana recalled the message the R&AW sent to Najibullah, who was staying at the UN mission in Kabul, to leave the country protected by the R&AW. The former president refused outrightly. Another effort was made through a reluctant Massoud, but Najibullah rejected the offer once again, arguing that the Taliban may not attack him.

'Despite our insistence and warnings about the Pakistan-Taliban trickery, Najibullah waited for some kind of miracle to